

INTRODUCTION

The most important thing to remember is that it's wrong to invest just for the sake of making money. Making money should be a by-product of doing what God has called you to do. Also remember that peace does not come through the accumulation of material possessions; if it did, the wealthiest people in the world would be the most at peace. Instead, they're often frustrated and miserable. True peace comes only from God.

Another important principle to remember when considering any type of investing is that we are to be stewards—literally, managers of another's property. More specifically, we are the managers of God's property. It's good to recall what Paul said to Timothy: "For we have brought nothing into the world, so we cannot take anything out of it either" (1 Timothy 6:7). Remember, it's not how much you accumulate that's important; it's how it's being used.

FIND THE RIGHT BALANCE

To allow material assets to erode through bad management is not good stewardship. It's a sign of slothfulness. But if you simply multiply and store them without purpose, you'll be guilty of hoarding, just as the rich fool did in Luke 12.

Investing is *not* unscriptural. In fact, in the Parable of the Talents recorded in Matthew 25:14-30, God gave to each of the stewards according to his ability and directed each to manage his portion well. One was given five talents, one was given three talents, and one was given one talent. Each was rewarded or punished according to his stewardship.

As you learn to invest money according to God's principles, you'll find that God will increase your opportunity to help other people. That is, in reality, the real purpose of investing: to increase your assets so that you can serve God more fully. If you do as the rich fool did and tear down your barns to build larger ones, then expect God to deal with you as He did with